EXPOSING APPLICATION SERVICES THROUGH PORT FORWARDING

In chapter 2, when you ran Catalog Service as a container, you mapped port 8080, on which the application exposed its services, to port 8080 on your local machine. After doing that, you could use the application by visiting http://localhost:8080. What you did there is called *port forwarding* or *port mapping* or *port publishing*, and it's used to make your containerized application accessible from the outside world.

By default, containers join an isolated network inside the Docker host. If you want to access any container from your local network, you must explicitly configure the port mapping. For example, when you ran the Catalog Service application, you specified the mapping as an argument to the `docker run` command: `-p 8080:8080` (where the first is the external port and the second is the container port). Figure 6.8 illustrates how this works.